Nature Advisors
Site Visit Report

Jason Blake
5367 Mission Woods Road
Mission, KS 66205

July 21, 2026

Nature Advisor(s):
Susan Brisch

Jason,

It was such a pleasure to visit your property and talk about your goals for your home's ecosystem support. The landscape plan developed by an outside vendor was helpful, and as you requested, our suggestions will supplement that plan, focusing on additional components of native gardening. The following is a detailed report of our conversation, highlights of your property's existing nature-supporting qualities, and recommendations. We hope that the report provides you with more ideas to further your conservation and wildlife adventures.

Thank you for your time,
Susan

Table of Contents

I. NATURESCAPING 3
II. NON-NATIVE, INVASIVE PLANTS & PROBLEMATIC PLANTS 12
III. WILDLIFE STEWARDSHIP STRUCTURES 14
IV. STORMWATER MANAGEMENT 14
V. EDUCATION AND VOLUNTEERISM 18
VI. RESOURCES 20
VII. DISCLAIMER 20

I. NATURESCAPING

We discussed opportunities around your landscape for the establishment of native habitat for bird and butterfly food/cover and, of course, your enjoyment as well. Our recommendations for each area of your property are outlined below. As discussed, ***we are not providing you with a particular design but*** rather lists of plants that are suited to the site conditions, will provide benefits to a variety of wildlife, and enhance soil health. Naturescaping is an ongoing process, and we discussed focusing on one or two areas at a time with the long-term vision for a regenerative, ecosystem-sustaining landscape.

If you'd like to learn more hands-on about gardening with natives, consider joining Cydney Ross's Discover Native Gardening sessions, held five times a month at the Anita B. Gorman Conservation Discovery Center, 4750 Troost Ave., KCMO. These in-depth sessions are a great way to learn hands-on by planting, enjoying the camaraderie of other native gardening experts and enthusiasts! Seeing the *right plants in the right place* and watching them grow are keys to having a successful Native Garden. If you can't be there to learn in person, our twice-monthly *Curious by Nature* webinars are the next best thing. Join virtual live sessions to learn about nature, small and large, across Kansas and Missouri. Bring your native landscape questions to ask our experts during the Q&A at the end of the program. Check out our most recent episodes, archived online here.

Please also consider joining us on Facebook at *Deep Roots KC – Friends of Nature Advisors*. It's a supportive space where you can post questions, share pictures of your garden's progress, and connect with others walking a similar path. We'll be there to cheer you on as you grow your own homegrown native habitat.

Plant Recommendations

When suggesting plants for your landscape, we have provided a short list of those we feel best suited for the area's site conditions, your interest, and habitat value. Each area may not be suitable for all the plants on the list, so you can select different combinations that work best for your landscape. Remember to plant with high density and diversity! The more layers, the healthier the natural community and the higher the habitat quality.

Two great starting points for plant selection can be our two short lists of Kansas City's top-performing, high-value native species: Deep Roots' "Sweet 16 Most Likely to Succeed" and Deep Roots KC Keystones.

Area 1 – Front Yard – East facing

You have done a nice job on the North side of the yard along the driveway with the Prairie Dropseed and native plantings of purple coneflower and columbine. The current landscape plant will provide a nice variety of native plantings across the front of the house. As we discussed, the front bed could benefit from additional area, therefore extending that area another 1-2 feet would be beneficial to accommodate the plantings.

If rabbits become a nuisance with your new plants, consider the following alternatives:

- Cage early growth on susceptible plants until they are taller and more established within a year. Use hardware cloth or chicken wire that is 2 feet high with stakes to fence off the entire area.

- Plant mint or allium species around the susceptible plants, occasionally crushing some of the leaves to make the scent stronger

Sod Removal

One of the easiest methods to remove turf grass is the use of cardboard. This method requires the placement of a layer of cardboard on the unwanted grass, overlapping the cardboard sheets by approximately six inches. Either soak the cardboard before-hand or soak with a garden hose once it is in place. You may want to secure the cardboard with yard staples or a few large rocks. Cover the cardboard with compost or mulch to smother the grass and prepare the area for planting. An advantage of this method is that you can cut into the cardboard and immediately plant directly into the area.

Pruning

We talked about some plants becoming taller than you would like. In this case you can employ the "Chelsea Chop". The Chelsea Chop is a late-spring pruning technique (typically mid-May to mid-June) where late-summer/fall-blooming native perennials are cut back by one-third to one-half to prevent flopping, reduce height, and encourage bushier growth with more blooms. Plants that perform best with this technique include Asters, Bee balm, Joe Pye Weed, Goldenrod, and Garden phlox.

Listed below is information on the plantings you have planned for the front bed per the landscape plan which are appropriate for this area of your yard:

- Blue Wild Indigo (*Baptisia australis*)—Long-lived perennial with smooth grayish-white stems, rounded leaflets, and tall spikes of blue, lupine-like flowers that emerge in spring. It typically grows about 3–4 feet tall and wide, forming a shrub-like clump over time and thriving in full sun to part shade.
- Shrubby St. John's Wort *(Hypericum prolificum)* – 3-5 ft tall, bright yellow flowers in the summer are covered in native insects, and with the stalks, they make a unique addition to cut floral arrangements.
- Prairie Dropseed *(Sporobolus heterolepis)* – Looks great toward the front of the border or weaving in and out of taller flowering plants. Use in native plant gardens, naturalized areas, prairies and meadows. Excellent in massed plantings. Provides food and cover for wildlife.

If you decide to add a few plantings under the redbud tree, once it is planted, listed below are plants appropriate for shade:

- Alumroot / Coral Bells (*Heuchera americana*) – Dense mounds of round, mottled foliage, 12 to 24 inches tall, are the main feature. Foliage can remain green throughout winter. Slender flower stalks, 24 to 36 inches tall, bear many pea-sized, cream-colored flowers April-June.
- Dittany (*Cunila origanoides*) – A small mint plant that is habitually orderly and clean in appearance. By September and October it reaches just 12 to 16 inches tall and wide, and is covered in small, heart-shaped leaves and tiny pinkish lavender flowers. May be used as a culinary herb.
- Oak Sedge *(Carex albicans)* – Small clump-forming perennial sedge with fountain-like form. Does best in part shade to shade in moderate soils. Use as a ground cover, low border, or between other species for mulch and weed control.

Listed below are plants that tolerate full sun that would look nice around the front lamp post. I would recommend selecting one or two species:

- Prairie Pussytoes *(Antennaria neglecta)* – low-growing ground cover with silvery-green leaves that form a dense 2-inch mat, making it useful in sunny, dry beds or as a filler in containers. In spring, white flower clusters that resemble tiny cat paws rise above the foliage, and female plants later produce wispy seedheads. This dioecious plant spreads by short stolons. Host for the American painted lady butterfly.
- Fameflower / Rock Pink *(Phemeranthus calycinus)* – A petite succulent with the foliage portion only 1 to 3 inches across and tall resembles the last few inches of spruce twigs. The fuchsia-pink flowers appear 6 to 12 inches above the foliage on thin, pencil lead-sized stems.
- Wild Petunia *(Ruellia humilis)* – A native perennial of great character with flowers that will remind you of the annual non-native petunia bedding plant. Charming, low growing clumps produce light purple/lavender, tubular flowers from June to September. The square stems and the leaves are both quite hairy—a natural defense against dry conditions.

Area 2 – South Side Yard

The south side towards the front of the house has a significant downward slope and will likely experience erosion issues. Planting sedges or grasses in this area will assist with erosion prevention. As we discussed, the area may benefit from a retaining wall or hardscaping with boulders and rock to provide some terracing and long-term erosion prevention. This may be something to consider in the future.

The plantings provided in the current landscape plan are appropriate for this area and may be further supplemented with sun loving plants as listed below.

Forbes in the current landscape plan:

- Purple Coneflower *(Echinacea purpurea)* – Staple of any many native landscapes, with wide appeal for hundreds of pollinators. Can tolerate partial shade. Goldfinches eat the seeds as fast as they ripen
- Black-Eyed Susan *(Rudbeckia hirta)* – This plant is easy to grow and grows fast to give a bright show of color but is rather short-lived. Will self-seed after blooming, to give another display later in the year. Flowers mid-spring through summer. Large yellow flowers with dark brown centers.

Additional Forbes:

- Bottle Brush Blazing Star (*Liatris mucronata)* – An earlier blooming, very showy liatris that doesn't get too tall. Thrives in dry, poor conditions and provides strong winter interest and seed for resident birds.
- Eastern Beebalm *(Monarda bradburiana)* – A clump-forming, mint family member that grows typically to 1-2' tall. Each flower head rests on a whorl of showy, purplish, leafy bracts. Flowers attract bees and butterflies when they bloom in May and June. The aromatic gray-green leaves may be used in teas.

- Rose verbena *(Glandularia canadensis)* – A trailing, meandering plant that spreads quickly to form an attractive ground cover. Intoxicatingly fragrant, flat-topped clusters of rose-pink to rose-purple flowers appear on top of stems for several months from early spring, intermittently to frost (March-November).

Sedges and Grasses

- Little Bluestem *(Schizachyrium scoparium)* – A small, non-rhizomatic, clump-forming grass with blue-green leaves that turn reddish orange in the fall. Fluffy silver seed heads are ornamental through winter. Host plant for larvae of a number of skipper butterflies.
- Common Woodland Sedge *(Carex blanda)* – can be used as grass-like ground cover and a native substitute for liriope. This sedge is one of the most versatile of all sedges. When in doubt, use this one. Sun, shade, wet, dry. Amazingly easy to grow and looks great all season long. Almost evergreen.
- Cedar Sedge *(Carex eburnea)* – Hair-like leaves. Plants spread slowly to form a fine-textured groundcover under trees, shrubs, and other dry shaded locations. Semi-evergreen. Ecological Benefits: Several species of butterfly larvae, leaf hoppers, grasshoppers, and beetles feed on sedge foliage.

Area 3 – Back Yard – West facing

There are two planting areas within your patio next to the house that currently have plans for a vining plant. You mentioned you would like an alternative to a vining plant; something more compact and tidier. With the amount of pavement around a small area of soil, I would suggest we treat this like a garden pot – using any of the sun loving plants listed below under "additional forbes" or use a shrub that is very heat tolerant such as Shrubby St John's Wort (listed above) or any of the asters. You can keep these shrubs tidy and more formal looking by using the Chelsea Chop method discussed above.

Shrubs:

The asters listed below can be pruned in the early season so that they maintain a neater, shrub-like appearance

- Aromatic Aster *(Symphyotrichum oblongifolium)* – One of the last wildflowers to bloom, this aster is loaded with blue-purple daisy-like flowers in late fall. By chopping the stems in late spring this aster grows into a tidy, compact, self-supporting mound and may even be grown as a short hedge or border.
- Heart-leaved aster *(Symphiotrichum cordifolium)* – Blooming August to September, this aster's flower is rich blue with yellow centers. It can tolerate full sun to part shade and pinching back several times before mid-July will maintain a bushier plant.
- Drummond's Aster *(Symphiotrichum drummondii)* – Tolerates part shade; fall-blooming small purple flowers with heart-shaped leaves. Spreads aggressively by seed, and is an ideal candidate for the "Chelsea Chop", cutting the plant down to 1' high in mid-June to keep it more compact. 3-4'H x 2-3'W.

- Blue Wild Indigo (*Baptisia australis*)—Long-lived perennial with smooth grayish-white stems, rounded leaflets, and tall spikes of blue, lupine-like flowers that emerge in spring. It typically grows about 3–4 feet tall and wide, forming a shrub-like clump over time and thriving in full sun to part shade.

The suggested landcapt plan plantings in the back corners of the yard are appropriate for this area, however, the number of Joe Pye Weed is likely too numerous. As we discussed, reducing the number of plants to 5 or 6 in total would certainly be sufficient. You could also spread the plantings along the entire back tree line instead of just in the corners of the yard. You may also want to supplement this area with a greater variety of plants and also include those that tolerate moisture due to the slope of the yerd causing rain to run off into this area, in addition to the frequent watering from the golf course.

Consider a mix of the following plants selected from the list of resources above to expand your current plantings.

Forbes in the current landscape plan:

- Butterfly Milweed *(Asclepias tuberosa)* – Bright orange, flat-topped flower clusters bloom for many weeks, June through July. Can be a host plant for the monarch butterfly and is a great nectar source for many other butterflies and pollinators. One of the 'gateway plants' for many native plant newcomers.
- Joe Pye *(Eutrochium purpureum)* – This is another very tall perennial, serving as a good backdrop for your garden.
- Lanceleaf Coreopsis *(Coreopsis lanceolata)* – Long blooming color, can be deadheaded and will rebloom. Nice compact form, with deep yellow color. I save the seeds from the first two deadheads to put in my bird feeders in the winter when the seed heads in my yard are empty.
- Purple coneflower, Black-eyed Susan and Bee balm listed above

Additional Forbes

- Pale Purple Coneflower *(Echinacea pallida)* – Tall bare stems are topped by lavender pink flowers with cone-shaped brown seed heads June-July. Good fresh cut flower or dried flower. Songbirds eat the seed if old flower heads are not removed.
- Glade Coneflower (*Echinacea simulata*) – a graceful native with drooping lavender-pink petals that bloom in June. Loved by wildlife, it attracts butterflies and bees, while goldfinches feed on the seeds in its distinctive brown cones. It thrives in sunny, dry soils.
- Marsh /Swamp Milkweed (*Asclepias incarnata*) – Swamp milkweed is a good candidate for rain gardens and will also tolerate average moisture. Flowers have a vanilla odor, reddish-purple in color and only provide nectar (no pollen). Blooms mid to late summer, 3-5' H.
- Garden Phlox (*Phlox paniculata*) -- Grow in full sun to part shade in average to moist soil. Plant in an area with plenty of ventilation to prevent mildew. 3-4'H
- Wild Petunia *(Ruellia humilis)* – A native perennial of great character with flowers that will remind you of the annual non-native petunia bedding plant. Charming, low growing clumps produce light purple/lavender, tubular flowers from June to September. The square stems and the leaves are both quite hairy—a natural defense against dry conditions.

- Showy Goldenrod *(Solidago speciosa)* – Stunning yellow flowers in the fall and a very important nectar source

Shrubs

- Buttonbush (Cephalanthus occidentalis) – Ball-shaped, creamy white flowers dangle from the beautifully-structured bush in July; favorite nesting site of birds, food and cover for butterflies and other pollinators; use in rain gardens, near downspouts; 5-10'H x 6-10'W
- Fragrant Sumac *(Rhus aromatica)* – This is a shorter shrub, that gets great fall color and is particularly good for slopes. 2-6'H x 6-10'W

Grasses and Sedges

- Blue Grama Grass *(Bouteloua gracilis)* – an attractive, small, clump-forming perennial grass with unique, showy flowers. Fine, blue-gray foliage turns a nice golden brown with orange-red hues in fall.
- Sedge (*Carex grayi)* Growing 2-3' high with a spiked club-shaped seedhead from May to October, this sedge will tolerate moisture and light shade.
- Palm Sedge (C*arex muskingumensis)* – Easily grown in average, medium to wet soil in full sun to part shade. This species does well in some shade but tends to flop in too much shade. 2-3'H x 2-3'W

If you determine you would like to create a bed around the Oak tree in the back yard, the link below provides a good start for plantings. You can start slowly with a few plants and increase the perimeter over time.

Plant a "Shadier Soft Landings" bed around and under your trees to protect the perimeter of the tree and to provide a "soft landing" for insects that fall from the tree and hibernate. The tree canopy will provide a great support network for hundreds of species of butterflies, moths, sawflies, and other insects – the primary food sources for songbirds. Introducing arrangements of shade-loving native plants beneath the drip line of the tree will not only serve as safe havens for developing larvae of those insects but will also reduce the footprint of turf grass that you must mow regularly during the growing season—a two-for-one beneficial practice. Consider some of these grass and sedge species in the understory

Basic Design Tips

One of the best ways to decide what arrangements you would like to try is to see examples. The Loose Park Native Garden in Kansas City has one of the most diverse native gardens in the region. Here is the landscape design & native plants in that garden. We recommend visits throughout the year to see the seasonal variations. The Anita B. Gorman Discovery Center also has many examples of bioswales, native plant gardens, plants for pollinators, and other native design ideas. We also recommend taking inspiration from the Deep Roots native landscape webinars or using various online regional sources, such as from Grow Native.

For more visible spaces, you might consider these tips if you'd prefer to create a more traditional/designed look:

- Planting groupings of the same plant species will provide a consistent aesthetic.
- Planting shorter plants in discernible patterns can help create a "tidier" appearance.
- Including grasses and shrubs will add structure and provide a backdrop to flowering plants.
- Placing large stones strategically between the plantings, defining borders, and creating pathways can help to emphasize the look of a "designed" garden.
- Lightly mulching will help to suppress weed growth and give a more finished appearance until ground covers grow to fill in empty spaces

Management of a Habitat Garden

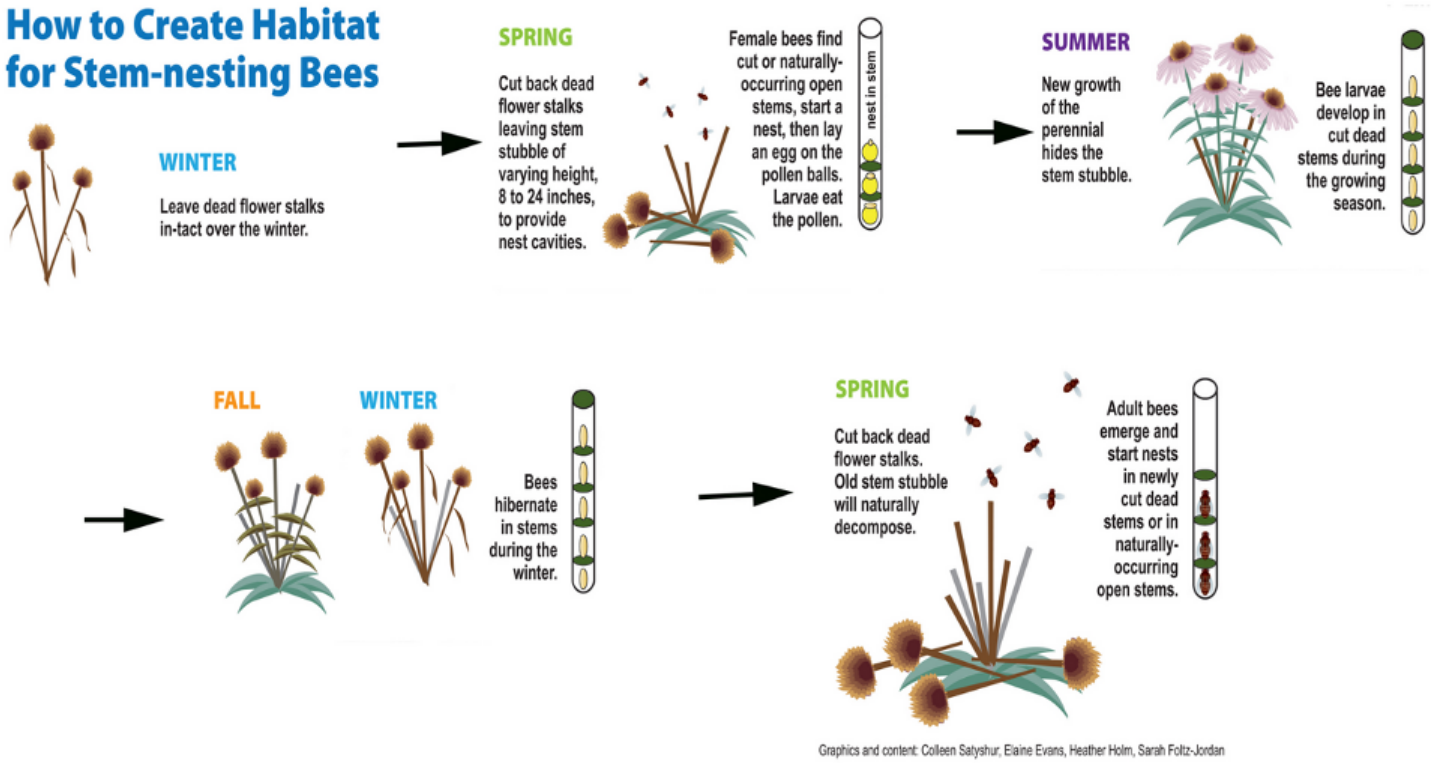
The management of native habitats is different from the maintenance of a traditional landscape. It focuses more on the health of the soil, plants, and respecting the cycle of nature in general. Best practices should be employed to continuously provide habitat for both ground-nesting and stem- or cavity-dwelling native bees.

Native Landscape Care Calendar from Grow native!

Reflections on Urban Native Gardening with Cody Hayo – Grow Native! Webinar

Water Smart: Steps to Establishing Your Native Plants

More useful information:
Native Garden Management Made Simple – Deep Roots KC
A Year of Native Garden Maintenance – Deep Roots KC
Maintenance of a Weed Free and Vibrant Native Plant Garden – ReWild Long Island (Excellent!)



[Our Bee champion, Heather Holm]

[Xerces Society] – anything you want to know about the invertebrate conservation

[Collecting and Cleaning Seeds from the Garden with Dolly Foster]

Seed Collecting and Sharing is a Year-round activity. Please consider donating to a seed bank.

Kansas City Public Library Seed Library at the [Ruiz Branch] in MO and [FL Schlagel Library in Wyandotte Co]

Professionals Who Specialize in Design/Installation:

Belfield Botanica Co. - 913.660.2420. - BelfieldBotanica@gmail.com

Bonny in Time - 913.961.0881 - bonny.in.time@gmail.com

Bluestem Habitat Restoration -816.714.8342 - bluestemhabitatrestoration@gmail.com

Bur Oak Ventures - 816.974.3462 - kyle@buroakventures.com

GardenNerd Consultations – 816.868.0449 - gardenerd@rocketmail.com

KC*Native* Landscapes – 816.262.5109 - info@kcnativelandscapes.com

Ksquared Landscapes – 913.815.0322 - info@ksquaredlandscapes.com

Littlefoot Studio - 913.660.2967 - Bdringenberg@gmail.com

Native Gardens KC, LLC - Nativegardenskc@gmail.com

Orris Horticulture – travis@orrishorticulture.com 573.355.0786, iris@orrishorticulture.com 816.785.3773

Polli-Native - 913.701.4565 - Paul@atgib.com ; nanette@atgib.com

Rogue Natives - 913.244.7327 - roguenativesllc@gmail.com

Simplescapes - 816-535-0764 – shawn@simplescapes-kc.com

Grow Native Professional Resource Guide

Plants (Where to Find Them):

Deep Roots Native Plant Sales link

Deep Roots KC metro native plant nurseries

II. NON-NATIVE, INVASIVE PLANTS & PROBLEMATIC PLANTS

We found the following invasive plants in your landscape during our visit:

English Ivy *(Helix hedera)*

Burning Bush *(Winged Euonymus)*

I would encourage you to partner with your neighbor on finding someone to remove the large area of ivy on the north side of your house, especially since they have reached out to you and seemed interested in this step. There is a list of vendors below that can assist with removal.

The burning bush will be eliminated by your landscape company. Continue to monitor the area for any small additional growth that you can easily remove.

For additional details on the ecology and steps to clear away these plants, see the linked references. Please follow the detailed instructions in the reference and follow all safety precautions.

Why We Care About Invasive Plants

Native plants struggle to compete with non-native invasives for light, nutrients, and moisture. Most of these plants were brought to the U.S. deliberately for ornamental value, erosion control, or other good intentions. Unfortunately, their spread was not impeded by insects and diseases that control them in their native country. Without intentional control, non-native invasives continue to spread, wreaking havoc on native landscapes.

Invasive plants such as Bush Honeysuckle have allelopathic root systems, which means their roots produce and release chemicals into the soil around them to prevent other plants from growing! Therefore, leaving a Bush Honeysuckle in your yard will make it more difficult for new plants to get established, even after it's removed from the landscape.

Non-native plants may look attractive. However, they do not support the reproduction of butterflies and moths or birds that depend upon their caterpillars for food. Native Missouri songbirds need insect protein most frequently caterpillars to feed their young.

No native plants = fewer native insects/butterflies/moths = further decline in songbirds!!

With landscapes full of non-native and invasive plants that do not provide nourishment, the insects have retreated to the countryside, forcing many of our native songbirds to do the same. We are depleting their food sources when landscaping with non-native plants. We strongly recommend visiting HOMEGROWN NATIONAL PARK[1] by Doug Tallamy for a full description of these interactions.

[1] "HOMEGROWN NATIONAL PARK." https://homegrownnationalpark.org/. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.

Professionals Who Specialize in Invasive Removal & Natural Resources Mgmt.:

Belfield Botanica Co. - 913.660.2420. - BelfieldBotanica@gmail.com

Bluestem Habitat Restoration - 816.714.8342 - bluestemhabitatrestoration@gmail.com

Bur Oak Ventures - 816.974.3462 kyle@buroakventures.com

Habitat Architects – 816.645.0026

Kansas Property Services - 785-845-4072 - kansaspropertyservices@gmail.com

Orris Horticulture – travis@orrishorticulture.com 573.355.0786, iris@orrishorticulture.com 816.785.3773

Otto's Environmental Improvements - 816.652.6886

Polli-Native - 913.701.4565 Paul@atgib.com ; nanette@atgib.com

Rogue Natives - 913.244.7327 - roguenativesllc@gmail.com

Grow Native Professional Resource Guide

III. WILDLIFE STEWARDSHIP STRUCTURES

Bird Nest Box

An artificial nest box provides supplemental nest opportunities for the birds while giving you and your family a chance to see them up close. Local bird supply stores are good resources for manufactured bird houses, many constructed of 100% recycled materials. Be clear about which species you are interested in attracting. Quality houses are built to accommodate different birds.

If you would like to build your own nest boxes, we recommend a couple of resources offered by the Cornell Lab of Ornithology. This article would be a great place to start for a review of best practices for creating a safe and successful birdhouse:

Features of a Good Birdhouse - NestWatch[2]

Visit this page for a thorough listing of nest box plans organized by species: All About Birdhouses - NestWatch[3] where you can find the ideal nest box plans to support the specific bird that you want to attract or perhaps have seen visit your yard.

Bird Bath

Birds seek water to clean their feathers for optimum flight ability as well as to quench their thirst. It can be as simple as a large plant saucer. Learn more here[4].

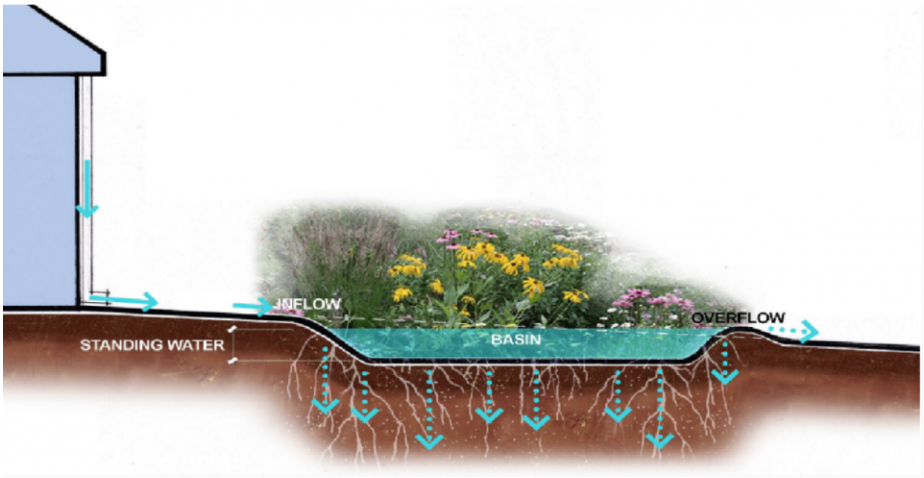
IV. STORMWATER MANAGEMENT

Cost-Share Reimbursement Programs for Residential Stormwater Solutions

The **Contain The Rain** program in Johnson County, KS encourages individual homeowners and businesses to make improvements to their properties to improve stormwater quality. Contain The Rain is a reimbursement program for most JOCO residents who install pre-approved sustainable landscape solutions that benefit the community's water quality.

[2] "Features of a Good Birdhouse - NestWatch - NestWatch." https://nestwatch.org/learn/all-about-birdhouses/features-of-a-good-birdhouse/. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[3] "All About Birdhouses - NestWatch - NestWatch." https://nestwatch.org/learn/all-about-birdhouses/. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[4] "Attract Birds With Birdbaths." 20 Apr. 2009, https://www.allaboutbirds.org/news/attract-birds-with-birdbaths/. Accessed 9 Aug. 2022.





Rainwater Harvesting

We recommend rain barrels or cisterns on as many downspouts as possible. They reduce stormwater runoff and erosion. In areas with a mixed stormwater/sewer system they can help prevent treatment facilities from being overwhelmed when heavy rains occur, causing sewage to spill into our waterways.

We see the most success with rain barrel systems that account for:

- Overflow – Even moderate rainfall on a roof can easily generate hundreds of gallons of water, quickly filling almost any size of rain barrel. Make sure it can overflow away from the house's foundation.
- Winter – Water expands when it freezes, and we have seen a number of rain barrels split open because there wasn't an easy way for them to be winterized.
- Mosquitoes – A sealed system or screen at the inlet should keep mosquitoes out.
- Debris – Leaves and dirt that wash off the roof can clog things up. A leaf filter or "first flush" system will help to keep it relatively clean.

- Weight – A 55-gallon barrel weighs over ***450 pounds*** when full. Make sure there is a sturdy base for it to rest on, compacted gravel or a small stone pad should be adequate.
- Algae – Where possible, situate a rain barrel or cistern in a shaded spot to avoid algal growth. If a sunny location is the only option, a dark, opaque material is recommended.

If you don't want to store the water for your garden, equip a low-pressure soaker hose made specifically for rain barrels; it will slowly soak into the ground and it's almost hands-free. Good Ideas for a Rain Barrel Soaker Hose[5]

For more information:

- Rainscaping Guide: Rainwater Harvesting[6]
- Local Rainwater Harvesting Resources[7]

Why we care about stormwater management

Heavy rains can wash insecticides or fertilizers used on lawns into nearby waterways where they do severe damage to aquatic wildlife. Even pet waste contains phosphates and nitrates that contribute significantly to harmful algal growth[8].

Vegetated surfaces help slow down rainwater runoff, encouraging water infiltration and the deposition of dirt and debris carried by rainwater, keeping pollutants out of the stormwater system or local waterways. Adding more native plants ***and a possible rain garden/bioswale*** will help to further reduce water runoff from your landscape and improve water quality in your community.

Professionals who specialize in raingardens or stormwater practices:

Belfield Botanica Co. - 913.660.2420 - BelfieldBotanica@gmail.com

Bluestem Habitat Restoration - 816.714.8342 - bluestemhabitatrestoration@gmail.com

Bur Oak Ventures - 816.974.3462 - kyle@buroakventures.com

Habitat Architects – 816.645.0026

KC*Native* Landscapes – 816.262.5109 - info@kcnativelandscapes.com

[5] "Good Ideas for a Rain Barrel Soaker Hose - Home Guides." https://homeguides.sfgate.com/good-ideas-rain-barrel-soaker-hose-88795.html. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[6] "Rainscaping Guide: Rainwater Harvesting - Missouri Botanical Garden." https://www.missouribotanicalgarden.org/sustainability/sustainability/sustainable-living/at-home/rainscaping-guide/rainwater-harvesting.aspx. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[7] "Rainscaping Guide: Resources - Missouri Botanical Garden." https://www.missouribotanicalgarden.org/sustainability/sustainability/sustainable-living/at-home/rainscaping-guide/resources.aspx. Accessed 13 May. 2022.
[8] "Harmful Algal Blooms | US EPA." 7 Feb. 2022, https://www.epa.gov/nutrientpollution/harmful-algal-blooms. Accessed 13 May. 2022.

Ksquared Landscapes – 913.815.0322 - info@ksquaredlandscapes.com

Polli-Native - 913.701.4565 - Paul@atgib.com ; nanette@atgib.com

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V. EDUCATION AND VOLUNTEERISM

Community Science

Consider these community science programs, especially those focused on native wildlife.

Feeder Watch[9] is a longstanding initiative of the Cornell Lab of Ornithology which runs from November - April. Participants choose a location to observe birds - your own bird feeder or another natural area - then enter your bird counts online, enabling you to contribute to a continental data set of bird distribution and abundance.

Monarch Watch:[10] Monarch Watch is a nonprofit education, conservation, and research program based at the University of Kansas that focuses on the monarch butterfly, its habitat, and its spectacular fall migration. There are many opportunities to engage with this organization.

iNaturalist[11] is an app which can be useful in helping you to identify various flora and fauna. A joint initiative of the California Academy of Sciences and the National Geographic Society, this tool also allows you to share your observations with trained scientists who can make valuable use of data collected by community scientists like you.

National Geographic[12] has assembled a large list of easily accessible projects.

Missouri Master Naturalist Programs (find a chapter[13])

Kansas Master Naturalist Programs (Johnson County, KS[14])

Stream Team:[15] Missouri has 110,000 miles of streams that provide recreation, drinking water and serenity for us and our children, but they need your help. Stream Team has a busy calendar of litter pickups, tree plantings, streambank stabilization, volunteer water quality monitoring and other activities.

[9] "FeederWatch - Count Feeder Birds for Science." https://feederwatch.org/. Accessed 8 Feb. 2022.
[10] "Monarch Watch." https://monarchwatch.org/. Accessed 8 Feb. 2022.
[11] "A Community for Naturalists · iNaturalist." https://www.inaturalist.org/. Accessed 8 Feb. 2022.
[12] "Citizen Science Projects | National Geographic Society." http://www.nationalgeographic.org/idea/citizen-science-projects/. Accessed 8 Feb. 2022.
[13] "Missouri Master Naturalist Programs." https://extension.missouri.edu/programs/missouri-master-naturalist/find-a-chapter. Accessed 8 Feb. 2023.
[14] "Kansas Master Naturalist Programs." https://www.johnson.k-state.edu/natural-resources/extension-master-naturalist/. Accessed 8 Feb. 2023.
[15] "Missouri Stream Team." http://mostreamteam.org/. Accessed 8 Feb. 2022.

Learning Opportunities

Loads of native plant educational programs exist in webinar format, but many in-person opportunities also abound. Programs include these offerings:

Plan It Native[16] is developed by Deep Roots and other partnering organizations. It presents an educational conference with nationally renowned speakers for professionals to beginners. Plan It Native 2026 will be held live and in-person at the Kaufmann Foundation Conference Center & Anita Gorman Discovery Center on February 10th and 11th, 2026!! Registration will be open in Fall 2025.

Deep Roots[17] offers free short webinars every month on the first and third Thursdays at noon. Our *Curious By Nature* sessions explore native landscapes in the KC area and throughout Missouri. The *Lunch & Learn* series covers topics ranging from restoring prairies to planting natives in the smallest urban garden, bringing professional insight to you right at your computer. Volunteer opportunities also exist at deeproots.org/get-involved

Missouri Department of Conservation's nature centers at nearby places like Anita B. Gorman Discovery Center and Burr Oak Woods Conservation Area in Kansas City. **Events | Missouri Department of Conservation**.[18]

Missouri Botanical Garden (especially the **Native Plant School series from the Shaw Nature Reserve**[19])

Missouri Master Naturalist Programs (find a chapter[20])

Kansas Master Naturalist Programs (Johnson County, KS[21])

Grow Native![22] hosts regular webinars about native plants.

Spread the Word

Please share your experience, the program and our resources with your friends, neighbors, and relatives. Every landscape that incorporates native plants becomes a wildlife habitat that is critical for the future of our birds, native wildlife, and our quality of life.

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[16] "Plan It Native – Deep Roots, KC." https://planitnative.org/ Accessed 8 Feb. 2023.
[17] "Curious by Nature, Lunch & Learn Series – Deep Roots, KC." https://deeproots.org/webinars/ Accessed 8 Feb. 2023.
[18] "Events | Missouri Department of Conservation - MO.gov." https://mdc.mo.gov/events. Accessed 8 Feb. 2023.
[19] "Classes - Missouri Botanical Garden." https://www.missouribotanicalgarden.org/learn-discover/classes.aspx. Accessed 8 Feb. 2023.
[20] "Missouri Master Naturalist Programs." https://extension.missouri.edu/programs/missouri-master-naturalist/find-a-chapter. Accessed 8 Feb. 2023.
[21] "Kansas Master Naturalist Programs." https://www.johnson.k-state.edu/natural-resources/extension-master-naturalist/. Accessed 8 Feb. 2023.
[22] "Upcoming Events – Grow Native!." https://grownative.org/events/. Accessed 8 Feb. 2023.

VI. RESOURCES

Websites	Books
Deeproots.org/webinars Bring Conservation Home – St. Louis Audubon Society[23] Grow Native!: Keeping Nature Near[24] Bird-Friendly Communities | Audubon[25] Monarch Watch[26] The Xerces Society for Invertebrate Conservation[27]	***Bringing Nature Home***[28] Doug Tallamy ***Nature's Best Hope***[29] Doug Tallamy ***Native Landscaping for Wildlife and People*** Dave Tylka. No longer in print, available used ***Tried and True: Missouri Native Plants for Your Yard*** - Missouri Dept of Conservation ***Native Plants of the Midwest***[30] Alan Branhagen ***Pollinators of Native Plants***[31]Heather Holm

VII. DISCLAIMER

Deep Roots KC, its employees or volunteers make no direct or implied guarantee about any of the recommendations in this report or discussions during the related landscape survey. Our advice is focused on selecting the right native plants for the right place to provide the desired habitat value. Yet the success of any habitat gardening approach is determined by many other factors as well, including, in part, the quality and origin of the materials, the installation process, and the maintenance routine. Landowners especially concerned about their ability to achieve the desired results are encouraged to consult the references included in this report ***including the services of a native landscape professional.***

[23] "Bring Conservation Home - St. Louis Audubon Society." https://stlouisaudubon.org/bch/. Accessed 17 Nov. 2022.
[24] "Grow Native!: Keeping Nature Near." https://grownative.org/. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[25] "Bird-Friendly Communities | Audubon - National Audubon Society." https://www.audubon.org/bird-friendly-communities. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[26] "Monarch Watch." https://www.monarchwatch.org/. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[27] "The Xerces Society for Invertebrate Conservation." https://xerces.org/. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[28] "Bringing Nature Home: How You Can Sustain Wildlife ... - IndieBound." 1 Apr. 2009, https://www.indiebound.org/book/9780881929928. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[29] "Nature's Best Hope: A New Approach to Conservation ... - IndieBound." 4 Feb. 2020, https://www.indiebound.org/book/9781604699005?aff=workmanpub. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[30] "Native plants of the Midwest ... Workman"– 16 November 2016, https://www.workman.com/products/native-plants-of-the-midwest/hardback Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.
[31] "Pollinators of Native Plants - Pollination Press LLC." https://www.pollinationpress.com/store/p5/Pollinators_of_Native_Plants_Retail.html. Accessed 28 Jul. 2021.